

Introduction to the Unedited Lectures

These 242 remarkable Guide lectures have been meticulously copyedited, not edited.*

The task of copyediting these lectures was not what it seemed at first glance. We soon realized that we needed to make the lectures grammatically clear and correct while at the same time to risk keeping them “unclear!” We strove to make only the most necessary changes. Our philosophy was rooted in the insight that changing awkward words or sentence structures may alter the “vibration” of the lectures or even the meaning of the Guide’s intended communication.

The skillful work of our copyeditor keeps these lectures open to the “treasures hidden in the field.” He treated the lectures as the riddles that they are meant to be. According to scholar Brian Swann, traditionally, the riddle plays out an ancient paradigm: concealment and revelation. Hide and seek. With the mystery veiled, the text remains open. Our copyeditor understood that to assert himself too intrusively, the material would remain closed. In observing the construction of ancient liturgies, Rembert Herbert, a liturgical scholar, said that “puzzling juxtapositions of these texts frequently point to the ‘beginning of another way.’”

Like all great spiritual writings, the teachings in these lectures address the reader from the “highest” and the “lowest” levels. They contain universal teachings, personal teaching, and the practical application of the teachings. Within one paragraph, the Guide can shift from one level to the next. Our copyeditor discovered he had to become the “Fool” with “dove’s eyes.”

Here is one example of the need for “dove’s eyes” of spiritual understanding. In one lecture-paragraph, the Guide said he would give a spiritual history of mankind. He then referred to the “dawn of mankind” and said, “Primitive man *is* . . .” One might reasonably change this to “Primitive man *was* . . .” However, in this case, it would not be correct because the Guide is referring not to a place in time, but to a state of consciousness. This same principle holds true when the Guide refers to “childhood” meaning a state of consciousness, not a place in time.

Under my guidance, the team for the four-year Unedited Lecture Project consisted of Tom Bullard, Cary Conaway, and Johan Kos. Tom was our copyeditor. Carey and Johan were hands-on overseers for the Pathwork Foundation. We used the Standard Bible (1901), and The American Heritage Dictionary, and The Chicago Manual of Style as our primary copyediting reference books.

Moira Shaw

* Most people refer to 258 lectures. In fact there were 16 Q&As that were given lecture numbers, but weren’t lectures. This occurred when Eva was vacationing, and wanted to provide an uninterrupted series of lectures to the group that subscribed to them. The copyediting team decided to take these out of the project, and we put them with the regular Q&As, where they may be found on this CD.